with countries against China—with the US in 1962–1963 and the Soviet Union in 1971. On the other hand, at other times, even when American and Indian policymakers have believed China to be a major threat, the countries' alignment has not been sustainable. The two countries *have* come together against China, but *only when* certain conditions are in place (i.e., when they have agreed not just on the nature and urgency of the threat, but also on how to deal with it).

While the US-India-Pakistan triangle has received a fair amount of historical attention, the US-India-China triangle has not. To some degree this is not surprising, given that policymaking organizations have structurally separated East and South Asia. This separation had the effect of placing India in a South Asia box in terms of scholarship as well. And that lens reinforced the traditional argument that the US-India relationship was characterized by estrangement during the Cold War and engagement after it. That, in turn, has shaped the narrative in academic and policy circles that the two countries have moved from being estranged democracies historically to engaged democracies in the present era.

By broadening the lens, however, this book reinforces the argument of more recent scholarship on the US-India relationship: that the two countries did engage during the Cold War. Moreover, this engagement was not just episodic. Indeed, estrangement and engagement were constantly competing elements in the relationship. Thus, even while the two countries had major disagreements on the Korean War—often differences over China that would spill over to other areas of the relationship—they were engaging at the working level, including with the US using India as a channel to and from China. Similarly, during periods of cooperation between the two countries on China, sources of estrangement like Pakistan and the Soviet Union had not disappeared. But their shared concern about China incentivized the two countries to deemphasize or manage those differences more effectively.

Those shared concerns also helped them overcome—or even helped change—the preferences of personalities, which are sometimes given too much weight in US-India narratives. This book does not argue that individuals did not matter, but it does show that structural factors could alter or overcome individual preferences. They explain, for example, how John Foster Dulles—long portrayed as anti-India—went from criticizing